ALDER & EMBER

Photography brief

Every image on the site: what the shoot needs to deliver, where each photograph appears, how it is cropped, and what must be in the frame.

20 October 2026

For Alder & Ember and the photographer. It lists each photograph the website needs, where each one appears, how the site crops it, and what must be in the frame. It is written from the layouts that are built, so finished files can go straight in.

Status. The homepage hero is approved (a real photograph, dark timber cabin with a glazed front, lit at dusk, with a hedge and silver birch behind it). It is the **look benchmark for everything below**. The other 16 slots still show clearly labelled stock photographs, which are not Alder & Ember's saunas and must be replaced before launch. For the hero's own specification, and the optional higher-resolution or vertical version, see Appendix A.

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1. The look, in one paragraph

Quiet, grounded and architectural: a considered timber cabin in a real UK garden, photographed at **dusk or in soft overcast light**, lit warmly from inside, with natural colour and nothing theatrical. Dark, fine-grained timber; a lawn, a clipped hedge, silver birch; a gravel base. Interiors are calm and honest about space and scale. Details are tactile and true to colour. No people's faces, no added steam or smoke, no heavy orange grade, no HDR look.

Palette to keep in mind (the site's own): warm canvas `#f4f0e8`, deep forest `#111c16`, timber `#795b45`, and a very small ember accent `#a54f32`.

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2. Ground rules for every image

1. **Accuracy comes first.** A photograph labelled as the Rowan, Alder or Ember must show that model, exactly as it is sold, in its standard configuration. Never use one model standing in for another. Note the model and configuration for every file.
2. **One garden for the three exteriors**, ideally the hero's garden, so the range looks like one place and compares fairly.
3. **No people's faces.** Where people appear (installation), they are shown from behind or at a distance, with signed releases.
4. **No added steam, smoke, fire or lens effects.** No heavy colour grade: neutral white balance, true timber colour, a warm glow from the interior only.
5. **No brands, logos, competitor products, house numbers, number plates or recognisable neighbours** in frame.
6. **Verticals stay vertical.** Use a tilt-shift lens or shoot a little wide and correct in post. No tilted horizons, no fisheye.

7. **Do not invent.** Construction details come from the manufacturer. Show the approved heater package only. No measurements, labels or annotations in the frame.
8. **Shoot with margin.** The site crops the same photograph to 3:2, 4:3, 5:4, 4:5 and square in different places. Keep everything essential inside the **central 88% of the width and 85% of the height**.
9. **Real projects only** for installation images, with the customer's written permission.

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3. Shot list at a glance

17 images are needed for launch. File names are the site's asset ids, so each delivery maps straight to its slot.

#	File name	Image	Appears on	Shoot as	Minimum size
1	`rowan-exterior`	The Rowan, exterior	Model explorer, collection, Rowan page (first image)	3:2 horizontal	4500 × 3000
2	`alder-exterior`	The Alder, exterior	Same, Alder page, the Alder campaign page	3:2 horizontal	4500 × 3000
3	`ember-exterior`	The Ember, exterior	Same, Ember page	3:2 horizontal	4500 × 3000
4	`rowan-interior`	The Rowan, interior	Rowan page gallery (second image), interior section	3:2 horizontal	4500 × 3000
5	`alder-interior`	The Alder, interior	Alder page gallery and interior section	3:2 horizontal	4500 × 3000
6	`ember-interior`	The Ember, interior	Ember page gallery and interior section	3:2 horizontal	4500 × 3000
7	`rowan-detail`	The Rowan, heater and controls	Rowan page gallery (third image)	3:2 horizontal	3600 × 2400
8	`alder-detail`	The Alder, glazed front from inside	Alder page gallery (third image)	3:2 horizontal	3600 × 2400
9	`ember-detail`	The Ember, changing area	Ember page gallery (third image)	3:2 horizontal	3600 × 2400
10	`detail-timber`	Exterior cladding close-up	Home: "Considered in every detail"	**Both** 4:5 vertical and 3:2 horizontal	3000 px long edge
11	`detail-interior-finish`	Interior timber and bench edge	Home: same chapter	3:2 horizontal	3600 × 2400
12	`detail-construction`	Insulated wall build-up	Home: same chapter	4:3 horizontal	3200 × 2400
13	`detail-glazing-heater`	Glazing frame, handle, heater	Home: same chapter, Alder page	4:3 horizontal	3200 × 2400
14	`site-access`	A real site and access check	Home: "From your space to first use"; Installation & delivery	3:2 horizontal	3600 × 2400
15	`installation-process`	A real installation in progress	Installation & delivery	3:2 horizontal	3600 × 2400
16	`closing-warmth`	Closing image: from the warmth, into the garden	Home: closing section	4:3 horizontal	3200 × 2400
17	`social-share`	Link-preview image (text-free)	Social and messaging previews	1.91:1 horizontal	2400 × 1260

Also useful, not required for launch: a vertical or higher-resolution hero frame (see the hero brief), and image sets for real installation stories (section 8).

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4. Image by image

4.1 Model exteriors (`rowan-exterior`, `alder-exterior`, `ember-exterior`)

These are the most-seen images on the site: the large stage of the model explorer on the home page (3:2), the collection and model cards, the first image on each model page (4:3), and the Alder campaign page.

- **Same everything for all three.** One garden, one angle, one camera height, one lens, one time of day. Shoot from the **front-left at a three-quarter angle**, so the front (door or glazing) and one side are visible. **Camera height about 1.3 m**, lens **28 to 35 mm equivalent**, camera level. The cabin fills about **55% of the frame width**. Do not enlarge or shrink a model in post: bigger models should look bigger.
- **Light.** The hero's light: **15 to 40 minutes after sunset**, deep blue sky, interior lit, the lawn falling into shade. Back-up set in soft overcast daylight.
- **Setting.** Lawn in front, hedge and birch behind, gravel base. Nothing else in frame: no bins, hoses, furniture, vehicles, other buildings.
- **Door closed, interior lit.** The glazed front or windows glow; the interior timber is visible.
- **Show what is distinctive.** Rowan: the compact cabin, with room around it to read as a small-garden building. Alder: the glazed front. Ember: the larger cabin, framed so the **changing area** is visible.
- **Composition.** Cabin centred in the 20% to 80% band of the width, 8% of air all round. Quiet sky or foliage in the top 12%.

4.2 Model interiors (`rowan-interior`, `alder-interior`, `ember-interior`)

Shown in the model page gallery and in the page's interior section.

- **Position.** In the doorway corner, **camera at bench-top height (1.0 to 1.2 m)**, lens **16 to 24 mm equivalent**, level, no fisheye.
- **Show.** Both bench levels with their depth, the heater with its guard and stones, the wall and ceiling timber, the door or glazing, the floor. The viewer should be able to judge how many people sit comfortably.
- **Scale cues, sparingly.** One folded undyed-linen towel on the upper bench, one plain timber bucket and ladle on the lower. Nothing else.
- **Light.** The sauna's own lights on, dimmed, plus balanced daylight or dusk light through the glass. No flash glare on glass. No steam: the heater is off or warm, never "smoking".
- **Accuracy.** The standard bench layout and the approved heater package. If the heater package is not confirmed before the shoot, say so, because it may need re-shooting.

4.3 Model details (`rowan-detail`, `alder-detail`, `ember-detail`)

The third image in each model gallery. Each one is specific to its model.

- **The Rowan:** the electric heater and its control panel with the bench edge beside it, from a three-quarter angle. Approved heater package only.

- **The Alder:** the **glazed front seen from inside**, looking out into the garden at dusk, so the glass frames the lit lawn and the hedge. It shows the model's main feature and the idea of the site: from the garden into the warmth.
- **The Ember:** the **changing area**: bench, hooks, floor, and the door through to the sauna. Calm, tidy and honestly scaled.
- Shoot **3:2 horizontal**, subject centred with 15% margin, shallow depth of field is fine (f/4 to f/5.6).

4.4 The craft chapter: "Considered in every detail" (`detail-timber`, `detail-interior-finish`, `detail-construction`, `detail-glazing-heater`)

A dark chapter on the home page with three tabs (exterior, interior, construction); each picture is cropped to **5:4 on desktop** and shown larger on mobile. Shoot every close-up with margin.

- `detail-timber`, **exterior cladding.** The thermally modified timber: board joints, a corner, the grain, the fixings. **Raking low light** to show texture, true colour, fresh and unweathered, no stickers or markings. Shoot **a vertical 4:5 and a horizontal 3:2 from the same position**, with the key feature centred.
- `detail-interior-finish`, **interior and bench.** A bench edge, the smooth timber surface, the board spacing, a backrest. Warm, low, even light. No steam, no sweat.
- `detail-construction`, **insulated build-up. From the manufacturer only.** A real cut-away sample of the wall, or the wall photographed during the build before the cladding closes. Square-on, even neutral light, plain background. **No ruler, no dimensions and no annotation in frame**: the site must not state a thickness the manufacturer has not given. Ask the manufacturer for the layer list so the caption can be written accurately.
- `detail-glazing-heater`, **glazing and heater.** Two frames, one slot: (a) the glazing frame and door handle from outside at dusk; (b) the heater and controls from inside. **Only the approved heater package.** The site uses one and keeps the other for the gallery.

4.5 Process (`site-access`, `installation-process`)

Both must be **real**. The site says "Genuine installation photography only" and a stock substitute must not stand in for evidence.

- `site-access`, **a real access check** on a real visit: a gate, a path, steps, a narrow gap, with a tape measure or the team's hands in frame to show why access is checked. **Overcast daylight.** No faces, no house numbers, no vehicle plates. It appears twice: on the home page beside "From your space to first use" and on Installation & delivery.
- `installation-process`, **a real installation:** the team positioning a cabin on its prepared base. Shoot from the side, from behind, or at a distance, or with signed releases. Visible PPE. Plain, unbranded clothing and vehicles. Include the **level, compacted base**. If a qualified electrician is photographed making the connection, only with their consent.
- Capture **extras while there** (section 8): arrival and delivery, the base before the cabin, the cabin on the base, the finished garden.

4.6 The closing image (`closing-warmth`)

The last image on the home page, shown at about 44% of the width at 4:3: the invitation to start.

- Our recommendation: **the Alder's glazed front seen from the sauna bench at dusk, looking out to the lit garden**, the mirror image of the hero. Dim warm interior in the foreground, the blue garden in the glass.
- Alternative: a quiet bench interior in warm low light. No people, no towels piled up, no steam.

4.7 The social-share image (`social-share`)

The picture shown when the site is shared on messages and social platforms. The site shows no link preview until an approved image of Alder & Ember's own work exists, so this is the cheapest way to switch it on.

- **1.91:1 (1200 × 630), delivered at 2400 × 1260.** Text-free.
- The Alder at dusk in the hero's garden, with the cabin **centred** and everything important in the **middle 80%**, because platforms crop the edges differently.
- Must be the owner's own photograph, not stock.

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5. Shoot plan

Session	When	What	Notes
1. Dusk exteriors	2 or 3 evenings, one model per evening (the blue window is only 25 to 40 minutes)	4.1 exteriors, 4.6 closing image, 4.7 social image, the hero companion	Back-up: the next morning in soft light. Lights on 30 minutes before. Lawn mown, hedge trimmed, base raked, glass cleaned, nothing left in the garden
2. Daytime interiors and details	Overcast day	4.2 interiors, 4.3 model details, 4.4 `detail-interior-finish` and `detail-glazing-heater`	Control the light with the sauna's own LEDs and soft fill. Wipe all glass and timber before each frame
3. Manufacturer	At the factory or from a sample	4.4 `detail-construction` , extra `detail-timber` frames	Get the manufacturer's written permission to publish
4. A real job	A real access check and installation day	4.5 `site-access` , `installation-process` , section 8 extras	Customer permission in writing first

Kit: full-frame camera, 16 to 35 mm zoom, 24 mm tilt-shift (ideal), 85 to 105 mm for details, a sturdy tripod, remote release, a small soft LED panel, a polariser, microfibre cloths and glass cleaner, undyed linen towels and a plain timber bucket and ladle.

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6. Technical delivery

- **Format.** RAW files plus **graded full-quality JPEGs or 16-bit TIFFs in sRGB**. Minimum sizes are in the table in section 3; larger is better.
- **Choices.** At least **three candidates per slot**, not just one.
- **File names.** The asset id from section 3 plus `_01` , `_02` , for example `alder-exterior_02.jpg` .
- **Metadata.** Keep the camera data. Put the **model and configuration** in the caption of every file. No watermarks.
- **Colour.** Neutral white balance, true timber colour, no HDR look, no heavy vignette.

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7. Rights and records

- **A written licence** covering website and marketing use, with no credit requirement (or the exact credit line), for each photographer.

- **A property release** from the owner of every garden or site shown, and a **location release** where the place is identifiable.
- **People releases** for anyone identifiable, including the installation team.
- **The manufacturer's permission** for construction pictures.
- **One record per image** (the site tracks this for every photograph):

File	Model and configuration	Date and location	Photographer and licence	Product evidence or atmosphere	Real customer installation?	Releases held
`alder-exterior_02.jpg`	The Alder, electric			Product evidence	No (showroom garden)	Property

A showroom or yard garden counts as **product evidence** for the model shown, but it is **not** a customer installation and will not be labelled as one.

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8. Installation stories (once real projects exist)

The "Our installations" section stays hidden until real, approved projects exist. For each one, shoot **6 to 10 images**, with the customer's written permission and approved wording:

1. The space before, in daylight.
2. The access route.
3. The prepared base.
4. Delivery and placement.
5. The finished exterior, in daylight and at dusk.
6. The interior.
7. One detail that shows care.
8. The finished garden from the house.

Never stage one to look like a customer's project.

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9. Not on the site yet (optional)

A team portrait for About, the manufacturer's workshop, a commercial or hospitality setting, and Care & support. None is used today. Add them only with real subjects, releases and approved wording.

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10. After delivery: what happens next

1. Each chosen photograph is cropped for its place on the site, and prepared in the file sizes that load quickly on phones and large screens.
2. Anything with text over a photograph is checked again for legibility.
3. A "Stock preview" label disappears from a slot only when the photograph that replaces it is marked approved, with its rights and a written description for screen readers.

4. The link-preview image switches on social previews.
5. **We need back, for every file, which model it shows**, so it can be used as proof of that model.

Appendix A: the hero photograph

For Alder & Ember and the photographer. It describes the one image the homepage opens with, what the website needs from it, and how to deliver it. Everything below is written to match how the site actually lays the image out, so the finished photograph can go straight in.

The photograph on the site today is a **real photograph supplied by the owner and approved as the hero on 20 October 2026**: a dark timber cabin with a glazed front, lit at dusk, with a hedge and silver birch behind. It is the look benchmark for every other image on the site (see the main brief). It is 1884 × 835 px, which is too small for very large screens, and its photographer, licence terms and which sauna it shows are still to be recorded. This brief remains the specification for a higher-resolution replacement or a vertical companion frame.

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1. The picture in one paragraph

A single, still, wide photograph of **one real Alder & Ember sauna in a real UK garden at dusk**, lit warmly from inside, standing on its base on a lawn with soft planting behind it. The cabin is the clear subject, large enough to read as a product, set slightly right of centre. The left of the frame is calm and dark so the headline can sit there. It should feel quiet, grounded and architectural: a considered object in a garden, not a lifestyle advert. No people, no props that distract, no theatrical effects.

The emotional promise is the site's line: **"A quieter moment, just outside."**

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2. Subject

- **Which sauna.** One model, shot exactly as it is sold. Our recommendation is **the Alder**, because it has the glazed front, which gives the warm interior glow that makes this image work, and it is the middle of the range. The Rowan and Ember are shot separately (see the main brief). Whichever model is used, the photograph must show the **standard product**: the real cladding, real glazing, real door and hardware, the real heater flue if it has one. No one-off custom additions and no options we do not sell. This image becomes product evidence, so it must be accurate.
- **Condition.** Brand new and clean: no scuffs, no weathering, no stickers, nothing left on the roof.
- **Door.** Closed, with the glazed front lit from inside so the interior (benches, warm timber) is visible through the glass. If the model has a solid door, light the interior through the glazing or window only.
- **Base.** A simple, honest base: compacted gravel, paving or a plain timber platform, whichever the product really needs. Do not show decking, steps, planters or an electrical connection that would suggest they are included in the price. (The site says ground preparation and electrical connection are assessed separately.)
- **Steam and smoke.** None added. Only a natural flue plume, and only if the shot is of a wood-burning configuration and it is really happening.

3. Setting

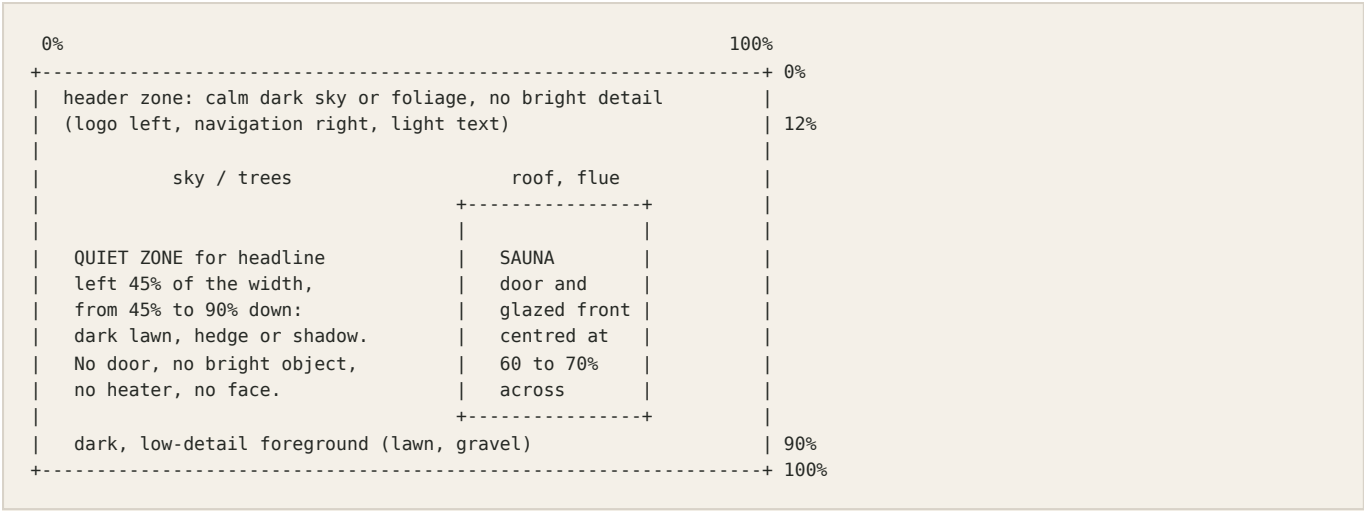
- **A believable UK garden**, not a mountain lake or a Mediterranean terrace: lawn, a timber fence or mature hedge, informal planting. Native trees are ideal. **Silver birch or alder** behind the cabin would be a quiet nod to the name.
- Naturalistic and uncluttered. Avoid hot tubs, pools, patio sets, bright cushions, string lights, garden ornaments, and anything plastic or brightly coloured.
- No visible neighbours, house numbers, number plates, signage or third-party brands. A distant, soft roofline of a house is fine if it helps the garden feel real.
- It should feel like a place someone lives. It can be a customer's garden (with a signed property release) or a showroom or yard garden. Say which, because it affects how the image may be labelled on the site (section 9).

4. Light and mood

- **Time.** Shoot in the **balanced twilight window, roughly 15 to 40 minutes after sunset**, when the sky still has deep blue colour and the lit interior is about as bright as the sky. That gives the glow without blown highlights, and it makes the foreground naturally dark, which the headline needs.
- **Back-up sets** from the same position: soft golden-hour side light, and a quiet overcast daytime frame. Daytime works only if the lower left of the frame is shaded (hedge, trees), otherwise the white headline will not be legible without a heavy darkening wash that would spoil the photograph.
- **Look.** Natural and restrained. Neutral white balance, true timber colour, a warm glow from the interior only. **No heavy orange grade, no HDR look, no crushed blacks, no fake atmosphere.** Shadows keep some detail; the cabin must read clearly.
- **Palette** to keep in mind (the site's): warm canvas `#f4f0e8`, deep forest `#111c16`, timber `#795b45`, and a very small ember accent `#a54f32`. Greens, natural timber, charcoal and the interior glow are all on-palette; saturated colours are not.

5. Composition (how the website uses the frame)

The homepage shows this photograph full-bleed behind the header, with the headline, short paragraph and two buttons over its lower left. So the frame has to leave room for them. The diagram is the **16:9 desktop crop**.



- **Sauna size and position.** The cabin spans about **45% to 90% of the width** and from about **22% to 85% of the height**. Its **door and glazing sit between 55% and 75% across**, never under the headline, which ends at about 45% of the width.
- **Quiet zone.** The left 45% of the width, from 45% to 90% down, is dark and low in detail: lawn, hedge, tree trunks or shadow. No door, heater, bright lamp or person there.
- **Header zone.** The top 12% to 15% is calm and fairly dark, because the navigation sits over it in light text. Keep the top of the roof and any flue below this line.
- **Ground.** The bottom 15% to 20% is darker, low-detail foreground. It is where the buttons sit, and on phones it fades into the deep forest panel under the image.
- **Bottom right** has a small caption on preview builds. Keep key detail out of the last 8% there.
- **Verticals stay vertical.** No converging walls and no tilted horizon.

The two frames to shoot from the same position

1. **Horizontal master, 3:2, native.** The site crops this to 16:9 (1280 and 1920 px wide). Cropping 3:2 to 16:9 loses about 16% of the height, so **treat the top and bottom 8% of the 3:2 frame as expendable** and put nothing essential there.
2. **A separate vertical frame, 4:5 or 2:3 portrait.** On phones the image sits on top of the text on a dark panel, about 390 × 480 px (4:5). This is a different composition, not a crop of the wide shot: the **whole cabin, roof to base, centred**, with the **top 25% quiet** (the header and menu button sit there) and the **bottom 35% dark and low-detail** so it can fade into the forest-green panel. If a 2:3 vertical is shot, the top and bottom 8% are expendable.

Social share image

While the camera is in position, also capture a **text-free 1200 × 630 composition** (about 1.9:1): sauna centred, everything important within the middle 80%. The site emits no social-share image until an approved one of Alder & Ember's own work exists, and this is the cheapest way to get it.

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6. Camera

- **Body and files.** Full-frame or good APS-C, **RAW**, 24 MP or more, on a **tripod** (twilight exposures are slow).

- **Height and lens.** Camera at **about 1.2 to 1.5 m** (chest to eye height), so scale feels human. **A 28 to 35 mm equivalent lens** is ideal; 24 mm only if the garden is tight. No ultra-wide distortion. A tilt-shift lens is ideal, otherwise shoot slightly wider and correct verticals in post.
- **Settings.** f/8 to f/11 for depth, lowest practical ISO. Bracket 3 to 5 exposures and blend naturally, or shoot at the balanced moment so one frame holds.
- **Focus.** On the glazed front or door, with the whole cabin sharp.
- **Variation.** 5 to 8 final candidates: different times of the window, a slightly different distance, and a slightly different angle. We will pick against the layout.

7. What to avoid (summary)

People or faces; competitor or third-party products and logos; added steam, fire or smoke; heavy orange grading; HDR; dramatic storm or cinematic skies; clutter or styling props beyond two or three quiet ones (a folded natural-linen towel on a timber stool, a plain timber bucket); anything implying included extras; a bright foreground or a bright object under the headline.

8. The other pictures the site needs

The main brief lists every other photograph the site needs (17 in all, with sizes, crops and direction for each). Shooting them in the same session and the same light is what makes the site feel like one place.

9. Delivery and rights

- **Files.** The RAW files for the selected frames, plus graded **16-bit TIFFs or full-quality JPEGs in sRGB**. The long edge should be **at least 6000 px** for the hero. The site serves up to 1920 px wide, so 3840 px covers high-density screens.
- **Licence.** A written licence covering **website and marketing use** with no credit requirement (or the exact credit line, if there is one), and a **property release** from the garden's owner.
- **Privacy.** No identifiable people, house numbers, number plates or neighbours.
- **A record for each image** (the site tracks this for every photograph): which model and configuration is pictured, date and location, photographer and licence, **whether it is product evidence** (a real Alder & Ember sauna, exactly as sold) **or atmosphere**, and whether it shows a **real customer installation**. A showroom or yard garden is product evidence but is **not** a customer project and will not be labelled as one.
- **Suggested alt text** (to confirm against the final frame): *"The Alder, a timber garden sauna with a glazed front, glowing at dusk on a lawn edged with birch trees."*

10. What happens after delivery

1. The chosen frames are cropped for each use and prepared in several file sizes, with a separate square crop for phones.

2. The headline and paragraph are measured against the real photograph at six screen widths. If the headline falls under 3:1 contrast (or the paragraph under 4.5:1), the darkening behind the text or the crop is adjusted, or a different candidate is chosen.
3. The photograph is marked approved with its rights and a written description, which removes any preview label.
4. The approved 1200 × 630 frame becomes the link-preview image.